

news feed

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hypothesis

Bluejacking

■ What is it?

Sending anonymous messages via Bluetooth is referred to as Bluejacking. Bluetooth-enabled devices, such as PDAs and mobile phones that are set to 'discoverable' mode in the range of the sender's device, can be bluejacked.

■ How is it done?

The bluejacker, as the sender is called, searches for Bluetooth-enabled devices in the area. A contact entry is then created where the message is the name of the contact itself. This contact entry is then sent to the pre-selected victim.

■ How do you prevent it?

Devices can be hacked into using bluejacking. So, enable Bluetooth only when needed. Also, ensure that you disable the discoverable mode in the Bluetooth menu. This prevents others from discovering you when they search for Bluetooth devices in the vicinity.

KaZaA goes desi

Film makers Aum Creates have struck a deal with Australia-based content providers Altnet Networks, to distribute the Indian movie *Supari* over KaZaA. This deal marks the first time a full feature movie will be legally sold over a P2P network. "KaZaA has already managed to create widespread awareness for *Supari*. Selling the full movie is the next logical step, and with a relatively low-budget movie,

this is a cost-effective way to reach the masses", says Padam Kumar, the director of *Supari*.



ILLUSTRATOR: Mahesh Benkar

Altnet Network is a partner of Sharman Networks, the distributors of KaZaA. The deal allows the 60 million users of KaZaA to download the movie for US \$2.99 (about Rs 150). Apart from the movie, users can also download individual songs from the movie. Nikki Hemming, Sharman Networks chief, has said that about 4 per cent of the users who saw a preview of the movie have already bought it.

Sony PSP to be a 2-in-1

Sony has revealed early prototype images of PSP—its hand held gaming device. It will contain two processors, based on the 32-bit MIPS R4000. There will also be two graphics processors. The sound subsystem, Virtual Mobile Engine(VME), is capable of 7.1 channel output. Communication is handled via USB, IrDA, 802.11 and a 4.5-inch, 480 x 272-pixel LCD screen. The storage subsystem, called Universal Media Disc (UMD), is a



DVD-like disk offering a capacity of 1.8 GB. The design of the device hasn't been finalised. Sony is trying to position the device along the lines of Nokia's nGage. Also, the PSP will not be a single device, but a range of devices with different sets of features. Apart from games, the PSP will be able to play back MP3, AAC, and ATRAC3 sound formats. It will compete against the likes of MP3 players such as the Apple iPod.

Cheaper calls

Net4India announced a reduction in calling rates over the Net by 20%. The revised rate, from Rs 4.95 to Rs 3.95 per minute, will be effective to 14 destinations including the USA, the UK, Canada, France, Singapore, Germany, Australia, and Hong Kong.

HP assembles

According to IDC, about 70 per cent of the Indian PC market in 2003 was held by local assemblers. Taking this into consideration, HP has launched International Modular Premium Assembled Component Technology (IMPACT). Under this scheme, HP will provide local assemblers with a kit consisting of a cabinet, motherboard, floppy drive, keyboard and mouse. Other parts such as the processor will be provided as optional components. Redington, a Chennai-based distributor, will provide the service and warranty. →

snapshot

IBM has sold its **20 millionth**

ThinkPad Laptop, making it the **best selling Laptop** model.

Source: ibm.com

China dumps DVD

China will announce the indigenously-developed industrial standard for the Enhanced Versatile Disk (EVD) next month. Zhang Yijun, deputy chief engineer of the Shanghai-based SVA group, is confident of the

next-generation digital disk technology, as China will now possess important intellectual property

According to experts, EVD players will offer five times the image definition offered by DVD players.